

Managing rows and columns efficiently is essential for navigating Excel's **1,048,576 rows** and **16,384 columns**. These shortcuts help you organize your data structure without needing to navigate the ribbon.

1. Selection Shortcuts

Quickly highlight entire sections of your worksheet:

- **Shift + Space**: Selects the entire **row** of the active cell.
- **Ctrl + Space**: Selects the entire **column** of the active cell.
- **Ctrl + A**: Selects the current data region. If you press it a second time, it selects the entire worksheet.

2. Insertion and Deletion

Once a row or column is selected, use these to modify your grid:

- **Ctrl + + (Plus Sign)**: Inserts a new row or column. If you haven't selected a whole row/column yet, it opens the "Insert" dialog box.
- **Ctrl + - (Minus Sign)**: Deletes the selected row or column.
- **Alt + H, I, R**: Inserts a row via the ribbon sequence.
- **Alt + H, I, C**: Inserts a column via the ribbon sequence.

3. Hiding and Unhiding

Perfect for cleaning up views in a "Salary statement" or "Sales chart":

- **Ctrl + 9**: Hides the selected **rows**.
- **Ctrl + Shift + (**: Unhides any hidden **rows** within the selection.
- **Ctrl + 0 (Zero)**: Hides the selected **columns**.
- **Ctrl + Shift +)**: Unhides any hidden **columns** within the selection.

4. Formatting and Resizing

- **Alt + H, O, I**: Automatically adjusts the **column width** to fit the longest text (AutoFit). This is useful for long strings like a "Student Name".
- **Alt + H, O, A**: Automatically adjusts the **row height**.
- **Alt + W, F, F**: Freezes panes. This keeps your headers visible while scrolling through thousands of rows of data.

5. Grouping Data

For complex engineering or data science projects, grouping allows you to collapse or expand sections of data:

- **Shift + Alt + Right Arrow:** Groups the selected rows or columns.
- **Shift + Alt + Left Arrow:** Ungroups the selected rows or columns.

Summary Table

Action	Row Shortcut	Column Shortcut
Select All	Shift + Space	Ctrl + Space
Insert	Ctrl + Shift + +	Ctrl + Shift + +
Delete	Ctrl + -	Ctrl + -
Hide	Ctrl + 9	Ctrl + 0
AutoFit	Alt + H, O, A	Alt + H, O, I